[1] Morocco's street children live a difficult life, often filled with harmful drugs and crime. Efforts to reintegrate them into families and schools are somewhat successful but experts say the problem is large and **its** root lies in poverty and difficult social circumstances.

[2] Othmane left his home and school at the age of fourteen to live on the street. He no longer wanted to see his mother fight the daily battle to get bread for his five little siblings and pay for his school expenses. "The street is not a better place to live in," Othmane says, "but at least **she** will not have to think about my daily living. In the meantime, I may be able to help her." Othmane carries bags of vegetables and other purchases for customers at a nearby market. In this way, he earns a few dirhams a day, enough to bring a little money back home.

[3] Othmane is one of the growing number of street children in Morocco. These are the homeless and marginalized youths without identity or family. The sidewalks, public gardens, and the buildings' doorsteps are their beds.

[4] In Casablanca, these children's main residences are alleys in the old city, the port, the train station, and the fruits and vegetables wholesale market. The port provides **them** with an opportunity to emigrate illegally. The wholesale market gives them the chance to work as porters. At the train station, they can earn little money from helping passengers or by begging from tourists.

[5] According to the most recent statistics, 7,000 street children live in Casablanca Wilaya alone. 8,800 more live in other major cities such as Marrakesh, Fes, and Meknes. The government and many non-governmental organizations have adopted a strategy of building centers to shelter some of these street children and reintegrate them into schools and families, but the challenge is enormous. The number of children usually exceeds the centers' capacities; there are not enough beds for all of them, and urgent is the need to act once to save those children.

I- COMPREHENSION (15 points)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT

A. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS (3 pt)

1. Why did Othmane become one of the street children?

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

2. What does he do to earn money?

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

3. What has been done to solve the problem of street children?

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

………………………………………………………………………………………………………

B. PICK OUT FROM THE TEXT EXPRESSIONS OR PHRASES WHICH SHOW THAT (2 pts)

1. Othmane doesn’t like living in the street. (paragraph 2)

…………….………………………………………………………….…………………………

2. There is a need to build more centers for street children. (paragraph 5)

…………….………………………………………………………….…………………………

C. FILL IN THE CHART WITH THE RIGHT INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT (3 pts)

Place of residence for street children	**The opportunity it offers**
The port	………………………………………………………………..
The wholesale market	………………………………………………………………..
The train station	………………………………………………………………..

D. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS OR EXPRESSIONS WGICH MEAN THE SAME AS (4pts)

1. origin (paragraph 1): ……………………..

2. clients (paragraph 2): …………………….

3. without a place to live in: (paragraph 3) ……………………..

4. a plan: (paragraph 5) ……………………..

E. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (3 pts)

1. its (Paragraph 1): …………………

2. she (Paragraph 2): …………………

3. them (Paragraph 4): …………………

A. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE APPROPRIATE WORDS FROM THE LIST: 2 pts

Non formal - cooperation - labour - non profit - conference

UNESCO is a ……………………………… organization which contributes to peace and security by promoting international …………………………………… through education, science, and culture.

B. FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH THE APPROPRIATE PHRASAL VERBS: 2 pts

Put on – set up – turn down – write down – make up

1. How could you ……………………………such an interesting job offer

2. …………………..…………..your coat; it's cold in here.

C. MATCH THE WORDS THAT GO TOGETHER TO MAKE APPROPRIATE COLLOCATIONS (2 pts)

1. equal 2. problem	a. opportunities b. diversity c. mistake d. solving

1. …………… 2. ……………

D. REWRITE THESE SENTENCES BEGINNING WITH THE WORDS GIVEN: 3 pts

1. The government should take measures to reintegrate street children into society.

Measures ……………………………………………………………………………………………

2. "I will take her suggestions into consideration," Jack said.

Jack promised ………………………………………………………………………………………..

3. Younes said: "I regret having accepted my first cigarette."

"If only I …………………………………………………..……………………….", Younes said.

E. PUT THE VERBS BETWEEN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE. 3 pts

"Our son (run away) …………………………..…………from home last week. We (still.look for) ………………………………him. His best friend says that he (not see) ………………………….…. him for two weeks," the father said.

F. MATCH EACH SENTENCE WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION: 3 pts

EXPRESSIONS	FUNCTIONS
1. Mrs. Simpson took her medication. Yet, she didn't feel better. 2. My friend Tarik is saving money so as to buy a computer. 3. Because of poverty, children's schooling is still a problem in many African countries.	a. Cause and effect b. Concession c. Defining d. Purpose

1. . . . . . .   2 . . . . ..   3 . . . .

WRITING (10 POINTS)

Taking drugs is dangerous. Write a short article to your school magazine about the consequences of drug-taking on youths’ health and education. (Approximately 150 words)

These questions may help you :

- Why do you think young people take drugs?
- What effects do these drugs have on their health and education?
- What solutions do you suggest for them?

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. Because he no longer wanted to see his mother fight the daily battle to feed his siblings and pay for his school expenses.
2. He carries bags of vegetables and other purchases for customers at a nearby market.
3. The government and many NGOs have adopted a strategy of building centers to shelter street children and reintegrate them into schools and families.

PICK OUT PHRASES: (2 pts)

1. "The street is not a better place to live in."
2. "The number of children usually exceeds the centers' capacities; there are not enough beds for all of them."

CHART FILLING: (3 pts)

The port: an opportunity to emigrate illegally
The wholesale market: the chance to work as porters
The train station: they can earn little money from helping passengers or by begging from tourists

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (4 pts) 1. root 2. customers 3. homeless 4. strategy

WORD REFERENCE: (3 pts) 1. The problem (of street children) 2. Othmane's mother 3. (Street) children

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

GAP FILLING: (2 pts) 1. non profit 2. cooperation

PHRASAL VERBS: (2 pts) 1. turn down 2. put on

COLLOCATIONS: (2 pts) 1. a. opportunities 2. d. solving

REWRITING SENTENCES: (3 pts)

1. Measures **should be taken by the government to reintegrate street children into society**.
2. Jack promised **to take her suggestions into consideration**.
3. "If only I **hadn't accepted my first cigarette**," Younes said.

VERB TENSES: (3 pts)

1. ran away (past simple)
2. are still looking for (present continuous)
3. hasn't seen (present perfect)

MATCHING: (3 pts) 1. b. concession 2. d. purpose 3. a. cause and effect

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

The following criteria should be respected while scoring the writing tasks.

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Writing: Taking drugs is dangerous. Write a short article to your school magazine about the consequences of drug-taking on youths health and education. (Approximately 150 words): Drugs Destroy Young Lives Taking drugs is one of the most dangerous problems among young people today. Some teenagers try drugs because of curiosity, family problems or pressure from friends. The effects on health are terrible. Drugs damage the brain and the heart, and they can cause serious diseases and even death. Moreover, drug addicts feel tired, nervous and depressed. Drugs also harm education: young people lose concentration and memory, miss lessons and fail their exams. Some of them finally drop out of school. What can we do? First, parents and teachers should talk to young people and listen to their problems. Second, schools should organize campaigns to explain the dangers of drugs. Finally, addicts need medical help and support instead of punishment. In short, the best solution is to say 'no' to drugs and to choose sports and studies instead.